

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

- <think>
- The patient has a history of long-term sadness, hopelessness, difficulty making decisions, and worsening suicidal ideations.
 - He also mentions past problems, guilt, and energy and concentration issues over the past 2 weeks.
 - These symptoms are indicative of depression, specifically persistent depressive disorder (dysthymia) with an episode of major depression.
 - The worsening suicidal ideations and recent onset of energy and concentration issues suggest a depressive episode.
 - Anhedonia, or the inability to feel pleasure, is a common symptom of depression.
 - There is no indication of mania, psychosis, or paranoid personality disorder.

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</think>

<answer>C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.</answer>